Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-10-24

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Song of Solomon 1:1-17

1 The song of songs, which is Solomon’s.

2 Let him kiss me with the kisses of his mouth— For your love is better than wine.

3 Because of the fragrance of your good ointments, Your name is ointment poured forth; Therefore the virgins love you.

4 Draw me away! We will run after you. The king has brought me into his chambers. We will be glad and rejoice in you. We will remember your love more than wine. Rightly do they love you.

5 I am dark, but lovely, O daughters of Jerusalem, Like the tents of Kedar, Like the curtains of Solomon.

6 Do not look upon me, because I am dark, Because the sun has tanned me. My mother’s sons were angry with me; They made me the keeper of the vineyards, But my own vineyard I have not kept.

7 Tell me, O you whom I love, Where you feed your flock, Where you make it rest at noon. For why should I be as one who veils herself By the flocks of your companions?

8 If you do not know, O fairest among women, Follow in the footsteps of the flock, And feed your little goats Beside the shepherds’ tents.

9 I have compared you, my love, To my filly among Pharaoh’s chariots.

10 Your cheeks are lovely with ornaments, Your neck with chains of gold.

11 We will make you ornaments of gold With studs of silver.

12 While the king is at his table, My spikenard sends forth its fragrance.

13 A bundle of myrrh is my beloved to me, That lies all night between my breasts.

14 My beloved is to me a cluster of henna blooms In the vineyards of En Gedi.

15 Behold, you are fair, my love! Behold, you are fair! You have dove’s eyes.

16 Behold, you are handsome, my beloved! Yes, pleasant! Also our bed is green.

17 The beams of our houses are cedar, And our rafters of fir.

II. Key Summary

• The woman says his love is better than wine, his name is ointment poured forth, and therefore the virgins love him; she says "Draw me away! We will run after you," and the king has brought her into his chambers (vv. 2-4).

• She tells the daughters of Jerusalem, "I am dark, but lovely," and asks them not to look upon her because the sun has tanned her; her mother's sons were angry with her and made her the keeper of the vineyards, but her own vineyard she has not kept (vv. 5-6).

• He compares her to his filly among Pharaoh's chariots, she calls him a bundle of myrrh and a cluster of henna blooms; he says "Behold, you are fair, my love!" and she answers "Behold, you are handsome, my beloved!" (vv. 9-16).

III. Passage Analysis

"I Am Dark, but Lovely"

> "The self-doubt the maiden had regarding her own appearance should not be overstated. She did feel, in some ways, unattractive and unworthy (Do not look upon me, because I am dark). Yet at the same time she could say she is lovely." [1]

In verse 5 she says two things at once: "dark" and "lovely." In verse 6 she asks not to be looked upon because the sun has tanned her. Then in verses 8 and 15 he calls her "fairest among women" and says "you are fair" twice.

She calls herself dark, and he calls her fair.

His "Name" Is Who He Is

> "The first line and the second line are synonymous parallelism, so 'ointment' means 'name.' In the Bible, a name often reflects the person's character and bearing." [2]

Verse 3 puts "the fragrance of your good ointments" right next to "your name is ointment poured forth," and then says "therefore the virgins love you." In verse 4 she adds, "Rightly do they love you."

His "name" stands for who he is, and she says the virgins are right to love him.

IV. Reflection Question

If someone looked down on you because of something about your appearance (like being tanned by the sun), how would you see yourself?

She asks not to be looked upon because the sun has tanned her, yet she still says "I am dark, but lovely" (vv. 5-6); and her beloved says to her, "Behold, you are fair, my love! Behold, you are fair!" (v. 15).

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, Song of Solomon 1 – "Rightly Do They Love You", https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/song-of-solomon-1/

[2] Chinese Christian Bible Study Resources (ccbiblestudy.org), 聖經精讀本 (Song of Songs Chapter 1 Notes), https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/22Song/22GT01.htm